State	*Govt Since*	*Chief Minister*	*Chief Minister's Party*	*BJP's Alliance Partners*	*BJP+ Seats in Assembly*
Assam	24 May 2016	Sarbananda Sonowal	BJP	AGP, BPF	86/126
*Assam (second term)	10 May 2021	Himanta Biswa Sarma	BJP	AGP, UPPL	75/126
Arunachal Pradesh	16 September 2016	Pema Khandu	BJP	JD(U), NPP	55/60
Manipur	15 March 2017	N. Biren Singh	BJP	NPP	37/60
Nagaland	7 March 2008	Neiphiu Rio	NDPP	NDPP	34/60
Meghalaya	8 March 2018	Conrad Sangma	NPP	UDP, PDF, HSPDP	39/60
Tripura	8 March 2018	Biplab Kumar Deb	BJP	IPFT	44/60

Source: Analysis by the author

THE TRIPURA MODEL: ALLIANCE WITH INDIGENOUS TRIBAL PARTY

In Tripura, where Bengali-speaking Hindus constitute a majority (about 65 per cent of the population), the BJP had natural advantages. Yet, along with appealing to Bengali Hindus, it also sought to assuage fears of cultural engulfment of the state's indigenous tribal groups by aligning with the Indigenous People's Front of Tripura (IPFT). This BJP–IPFT alliance, with its slogan of 'Chalo Paltai' (Let's Overturn) ended up winning a majority of the state's tribal seats. As Ram Madhav—the senior leader who oversaw that campaign and who was entrusted by the BJP with its Northeast expansion till 2020—explained, 'Tripura has two distinct groups: Bengali-speaking people and the tribals who are about 35 per cent … Tribals felt they were being discriminated against, that their language, culture and way of life was endangered. So we promised them "unity" and entered into an alliance with IPFT.'[92] This alliance